



Epic Games buys 3Lateral

3Lateral is a game studio focused on designing more realistic computer-generated human characters. <https://digit.in/feb19-69>



Amazon introduces delivery robot

Scout, an all-electric self-driving vehicle that will maneuver across sidewalks to deliver purchased items to customers. <https://digit.in/feb19-70>

any kind of personal information for the bot during evaluation. It is only revealed upon the manual intervention of any kind. Even the individual answers are rated distinctly, without any connection to personal information. Impress.ai aims to solve the problems typically associated with the initial stages of recruitment.

ON-DEMAND INTERVIEWS - MONJIN

Once your application and resume does go through, the next stage – the actual in-person interview. Quite often, interviewers and potential candidates have to go back and forth several times before an interview can be scheduled at a time convenient to both. Even when that does happen, there's often no way to go back to it and analyse it beyond the impression that was created during the interview itself. This is the problem that Monjin is trying to solve.

Monjin is a video interview platform that offers a number of interview models that helps candidates, interviewers and recruiting companies. Candidates signing up on the platform can opt for a one-way interview based on their skills. This interview is then analysed by industry experts who sign up with Monjin as interviewers. According to Mr Abhijeet Kashyape, CEO & Co-founder at Monjin, the candidates then receive a detailed analysis of their technical

skills, as well as other aspects of an interview such as their body language and soft skills.

In future versions, candidates will also

be able to share their interview and its analysis beyond the Monjin platform. Industry experts who sign up on Monjin as interviewers get paid for each interview they take. There are four ways in which a recruiting company can use Monjin's services.

- **Our Candidates Our Interviewers:** An end to end solution where companies access Monjin's repository of completed interviews in their

requirement area to shortlist candidates directly.

- **Your Candidates Our Interviewers:** Monjin serves to provide the interview experts and the platforms, and also handles scheduling. This enables companies to hire beyond their expertise area.
- **Your Candidates Your Interviewers:** Monjin

only serves as the workflow and scheduling manager here. Multiple stakeholders can be involved.

- **One way interviews:** the first type mentioned earlier, candidates can record responses to pre-determined questions in their expertise area.

The overall proposition of on-demand interviews, that are not bound by location or availability of expertise is to smoothen the recruitment process.

BLUE-COLLAR LIFECYCLE MANAGEMENT - BETTERPLACE

A large portion of India's workforce is in the blue collar segment - or manual labour. In recent times, the evolution of the on-demand economy and the rise of startups that provide such services has led to a boom in blue collar jobs. However, the corresponding infrastructure to manage these employees didn't evolve at the same pace until very recently. We might have companies like Betterplace to thank for that.

Betterplace acts as a lifecycle management platform for blue-collar employees. Today, someone employed for a white-collar role

doesn't have to consider the possibility of a credit score, a background verification, medical insurance and reimbursements, other forms of insurance, loan approvals etc. However, these things, taken for granted by the white collar segment, are often not available for blue-collar employees. For instance, how do you generate the credit score for someone who has been paid in cash their entire career?

This is where Betterplace steps in. Right from the moment of planning job requirements, Betterplace assists companies find the right people for the right roles. They have on ground contractors and infrastructure in multiple cities to find people who are seeking jobs. These people are brought on-board onto their platform after

thorough background checks and data verification. Correspondingly, once they are onboard, they exist as a single entity on their platform. How does this help? Say Raj gets a job at employer A, works there for 3 years and then gets a better opportunity at employer B. Now, when employer B seeks to know more about Raj's background, he can grant the employer access to his Betterplace profile which would include, among other things, his past employment records. It would also include his insurance information, track record, any known criminal records, and more than 200 other data points that would help a company make an informed decision. Interestingly, it also ends up helping the employee avail services such as loans, insurance due to their financial records being readily available.

This scale of data collection also provides interesting opportunities for insights. "Hiring trends are one part of it," says Mr Pravin Agarwala, CEO, Betterplace, "We also help employers identify where their employees come from, which age group do they belong to etc. We also help the individual identify where potential opportunities can emerge from." Betterplace also provides attendance management systems for employers and learning modules for employees to perform their respective responsibilities better. Other services like providing a vehicle for delivery personnel are also available. Overall, their objective is to remove the hurdles between a potential blue collar employee and a company looking to recruit them and keep them employed. 

